

The background of the entire cover is a romantic scene of a man and a woman looking at each other. The woman, on the left, has long, dark, curly hair and is wearing a dark red, spaghetti-strap dress. The man, on the right, has short dark hair and a beard, and is wearing a light blue button-down shirt. They are standing in front of a city skyline at night, with warm, golden light from the setting or rising sun. Strings of warm white lights are draped across the scene, adding to the romantic atmosphere.

THE *Diaspora* Love Story

COMPLETE SEASON 1

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THE DIASPORA LOVE STORY

SEASON 1

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FIRST EDITION





DEDICATION



For those who left home
in search of something greater...



For those who endure the loneliness,
chase their dreams,
and keep believing in a better tomorrow.



And for those who *found love*
in places they never expected.





ACKNOWLEDGEMENTS



Every story is born from inspiration,
but it is shaped by the people and moments
that surround the journey.



I want to express my deepest gratitude to
everyone who believed in this vision,
encouraged this dream, and supported
this journey in ways both seen and unseen.



To the friends, family, and everyone who shared
their stories, their strength, and their truth—
thank you. You are part of every page.



To every dreamer in the diaspora—



this story is for you.



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THE
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CHAPTER 1
A NEW BEGINNING

The cold hit him first.

Not the kind that bites immediately, but the one that creeps in slowly—through the sleeves, past the skin, settling somewhere deep inside the bones.

Bayo stood still for a moment outside the airport, one hand gripping his suitcase, the other buried in his pocket.

Cars moved fast.
People walked with purpose.
No one looked at him.

This was it.

A new country.
A new life.
A new version of himself waiting to be built.

He exhaled slowly, watching his breath disappear into the air.

“Welcome,” he whispered to himself, though nothing about the moment felt welcoming.

Still... he smiled.

Because behind the uncertainty, behind the silence of being unknown in a foreign land, there was something stronger—

Hope.



CHAPTER 2

THE QUIET DREAM

Days turned into routines.

Routines turned into survival.

Bayo learned quickly that the dream of the diaspora wasn't loud—it was quiet, demanding, and often lonely.

Long shifts. Silent commutes. Conversations that never went beyond 'hello' and 'thank you.'

His small room became his world.

A bed.

A table.

A window that showed a city that didn't know his name.

Some nights, he would sit by that window and watch people below.

Laughing. Living, *Belonging*.

He wondered when that would be him.
Or if it ever would.





CHAPTER 3

THE ENCOUNTER

It happened on an ordinary evening.

That's how life changes sometimes—**notwith** noise, but with quiet coincidence.

The café was warm, filled with the soft hum of conversations and the smell of coffee. Bayo stood in line, distracted, scrolling through his phone.

Then—

“Sorry...”

He looked up.

And time slowed

She stood there, her eyes briefly locking with his as she reached for a dropped napkin. There was something about her—something calm, yet powerful.

“Here,” he said, handing it to her.

“Thank you,” she replied, her voice soft but confident.

Teju.

He didn't know her name yet, but somehow



A romantic scene on a rooftop at night. A man and a woman are sitting at a table, looking at each other. The woman has curly hair and is wearing a dark top. The man has short hair and a beard, wearing a light blue shirt. They are surrounded by soft, warm light from string lights above them. In the background, a city skyline is visible under a twilight sky. The overall mood is intimate and romantic.

CHAPTER 4

SOMETHING DIFFERENT

They met again.

And again.

Not planned. Not forced. Just... natural.

Conversations started small—simple questions, shared laughter. But beneath it all, there was something neither of them could ignore.

Connection.

Not the kind built on convenience.
The kind that felt... familiar.

‘I Do you ever feel like you’re is living two lives?
Teju asked one evening.

Bayo leaned back slightly.
“Every day.”

She smiled. “Good... so it’s not just me.”

That was the moment he knew.

She undersond.

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CHAPTER 5

THE LANGUAGE
OF SILENCE

CHAPTER 5

THE LANGUAGE
OF SILENCE



There's a kind of comfort that doesn't need words.

And somehow... they found it.

Their meetings became frequent—not planned, not scheduled, just naturally happening like the city itself had decided they should keep crossing paths.

Sometimes they talked for hours.

Other times... they didn't talk at all.

And yet, those silent moments felt just as full.

Bayo noticed the details.

The way she wrapped her hands around her cup when she was thinking.

The way her eyes softened when she laughed.

The pauses she took before answering *questions*—as if she was choosing honesty over *convenience*.

Teju noticed things too.

His restraint.

His calmness.

The way he listened—not just to respond, but to understand.

“You’re different,” she said one evening.

He raised an eyebrow.

“Different how?”

She shrugged lightly.

“You don’t try too hard.”

He smiled faintly.

“That’s because I already know life is hard enough.”

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CHAPTER 6
CLOSE ENOUGH

It wasn't planned.

It never was.

The cinema was dimly lit, the kind of place where reality softened and people became silhouettes.

They sat side by side, close—but not close enough.

The movie played, but neither of them was fully watching.

There was an awareness.
Of presence.
Of proximity.

At one point, quietly building.

At one point, their hands brushed.
Just slightly.

But it lingered.

Neither of them pulled away immediately.

And in that brief moment...

Everything felt louder than the film itself.

Bayo glanced sideways.

Teju was still looking forward—but there was a small smile on her lips.

Not obvious.

Not exaggerated.

Just enough.

That was when he knew.

This wasn't just connection anymore.

It was becoming something else.

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CHAPTER 7

THE ILLUSION OF PERFECTION

Happiness, when it arrives, rarely announces its limits.

It simply settles in... making everything feel effortless.

They laughed more.

Walked longer.

Stayed out later than they should have.

The chy began to feel different— not because it had changed, but because they were no longer experiencing it alone.

“Maybe this place isn’t so bad,” Bayo said one evening.

Teju looked at him, amused.

“Oh, now you’re adjusting?”

From the outside, they looked perfect.

The kind of couple people notice.

Effortless. Balanced. Happy.

But perfection...

Is often just a moment in time.

Not a permanent state.

And somewhere beneath the laughter...

Life was still waiting.

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CHAPTER 8
THE THINGS UNSAID

It started subtly.
Small pauses in conversation.
Moments where words could have been
said ... but whern't.
Bayo began noticing changes.
Not dramatic ones.
Just... shifts.
Teju became slightly distant at times.
Not physically.
Emotionally.
“Everything okay?” he asked one afternoon.
She nodded too quickly.
He studied her for a moment longer than usual.

That night, Bayo sat alone in his room.
The same room that once felt empty.
Now it felt... uncertain.
Because for the first time since meeting her—
He realized something important.
He didn't just enjoy her presence anymore.
He needed it.
And that realization...
Came with risk.



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CHAPTER 9

THE NIGHT THAT CHANGED EVERYTHING

The music was too loud to think.

Maybe that was the point.

Lights flashed in deep purples and electric blues, cutting through the darkness like fragments of another world.

Teju moved differently that night.

Freer.

Less guarded.

More distant.

Bayo watched her from across the room.

Not with jealousy.

But with confusion.

Because something felt... off.

She laughed at something someone said—someone who wasn't him.

And for the first time.

When she finally walked back to him, her energy hadn't changed.

But his had.

"You okay?" she asked.

He nodded slowly.

"Yeah... just watching."

"Watching what?"

He hesitated.

"Trying to understand."

Her expression shifted—just slightly.

But enough.

That was the moment the balance changed.



CHAPTER 10

WHEN WORDS BECOME WEAPONS



Silence followed them home.

Not peaceful silence.

The heavy kind.

The kind that waits...for something to break it.

It didn't take long.

"What was that tonight?" Bayo asked, his voice controlled but firm.

Teju turned, folding her arms *slightly*.

"What do you mean?"

"You know what I mean."

She sighed.

"I was just having fun."

"That didnt feel like "just fun."

Her eyes narrowed slightly.

"So now I need permission to enjoy myself?"

"That's not what I'm saying."

Then what are you saying, Bayo?"

"*What was that tonight?*" Bayo asked, his voice controlled but firm.

Teju turned, folding her arms *slightly*.

"What do you mean?"

"You know what I mean."

"I was just having fun."

"That didn't feel like "just fun."

There it i was.

Tension.

Real. Raw. Unfiltered.

The words hung in the air.

Heavy.

Unavoidable.

Teju looked at him.... really looked at him.

And for the first time—

There was distance in her eyes.

Not physical.

Emotional



CHAPTER 11

THE SILENCE BETWEEN US

Silence has many forms.

There's the peaceful kind...
the one that feels like rest.

And then there's this kind.

The one that sits between two people
who used to understand each other
without speaking.

Bayo stared at his phone longer than
he should have.

Reading the *same messages over and over...*
as if something hidden would suddenly
appear between the lines.

But there was nothing.

The next few days felt... different.

Not dramatically.

But enough.

Messages became shorter.

Replies came slower.

Conversations lost their depth.

"Good morning."

"How was your day?"

"Fine."

That evening, he sat by his window again.

The same view.

The same street.

But everything felt heavier.

Because now...

He wasn't just alone in the city.

He was slowly becoming *alone...*
in something that once felt like home.

A man and a woman are standing on a busy city street at night. The man, on the left, is wearing a white button-down shirt and looking down. The woman, on the right, is wearing a red spaghetti-strap top and looking off to the side. The background is filled with the blurred lights and movement of a city at night.

CHAPTER 12

ALONE AGAIN

The city hadn't changed.

But it felt colder.

Bayo walked without direction, hands buried deep in his pockets, his steps slow and uncommitted.

People passed him.
Laughing. Talking. Living.
The same way they always had.

But today...
It felt louder.
Like a reminder.

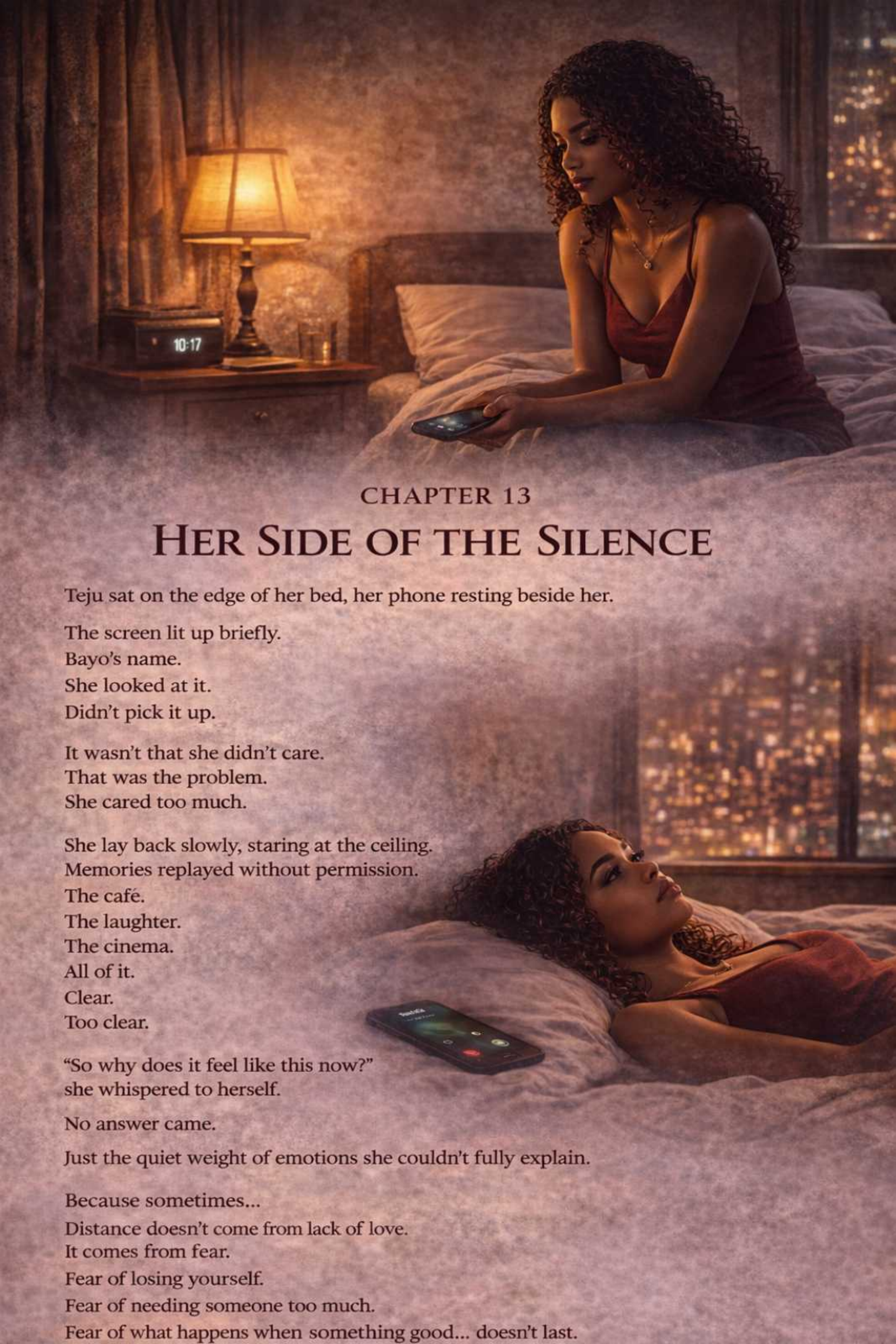
He stopped at a familiar street corner—the one they used to walk past together.

For a moment, he stood there.
Still.

As if waiting for something.
Or someone.

Nothing came.

He exhaled slowly, shaking his head.
'You're thinking too much,' he muttered to himself.
But deep down...



CHAPTER 13

HER SIDE OF THE SILENCE

Teju sat on the edge of her bed, her phone resting beside her.

The screen lit up briefly.

Bayo's name.

She looked at it.

Didn't pick it up.

It wasn't that she didn't care.

That was the problem.

She cared too much.

She lay back slowly, staring at the ceiling.

Memories replayed without permission.

The café.

The laughter.

The cinema.

All of it.

Clear.

Too clear.

"So why does it feel like this now?"
she whispered to herself.

No answer came.

Just the quiet weight of emotions she couldn't fully explain.

Because sometimes...

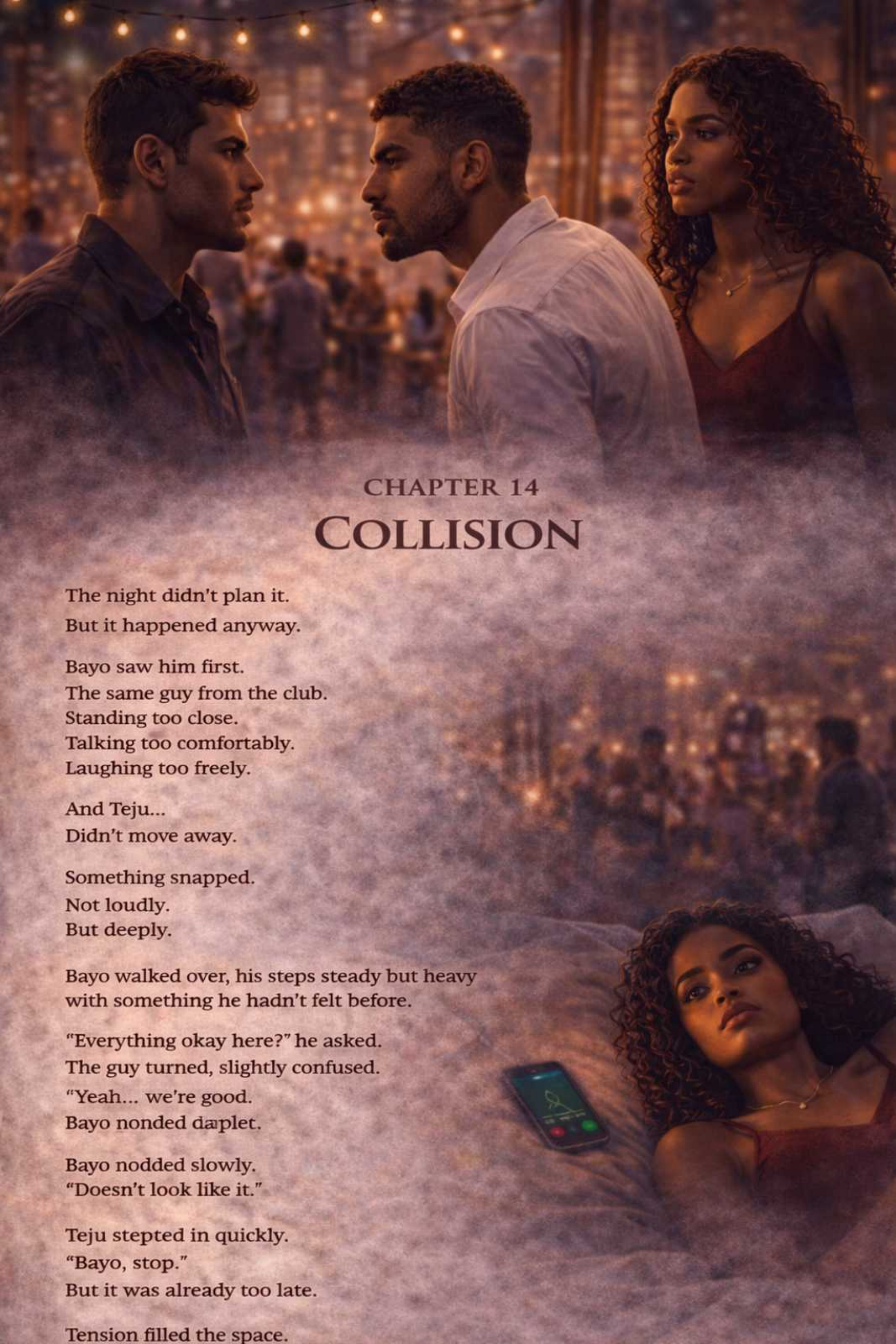
Distance doesn't come from lack of love.

It comes from fear.

Fear of losing yourself.

Fear of needing someone too much.

Fear of what happens when something good... doesn't last.



CHAPTER 14

COLLISION

The night didn't plan it.
But it happened anyway.

Bayo saw him first.
The same guy from the club.
Standing too close.
Talking too comfortably.
Laughing too freely.

And Teju...
Didn't move away.

Something snapped.
Not loudly.
But deeply.

Bayo walked over, his steps steady but heavy
with something he hadn't felt before.

"Everything okay here?" he asked.
The guy turned, slightly confused.
"Yeah... we're good."
Bayo nodded dæplet.

Bayo nodded slowly.
"Doesn't look like it."

Teju stepped in quickly.
"Bayo, stop."
But it was already too late.

Tension filled the space.

A man and a woman are standing in the rain, looking at each other. The woman is on the left, wearing a dark red spaghetti-strap top, and the man is on the right, wearing a light blue button-down shirt. They are both looking at each other with serious expressions. The background is a blurred city street at night with many lights reflecting off the rain.

CHAPTER 15

THE WALK AWAY

Rain always makes moments feel heavier.
As if the world itself is reacting.

Teju walked fast.
Not running.
But not slowing down either.
The rain soaked through her clothes,
her hair clinging slightly to her face.
She didn't wipe it away.
Didn't care.

"Teju, wait!" Bayo's voice came from behind.
She didn't stop.

"Teju!"
Finally—she turned.

And everything that she and been building... finally surfaced.

"I can't do this," she said.
Her voice wasn't loud.
But it was final.

"Do what?" Bayo asked, though he already knew.

"This... whatever this is becoming."

He stepped closer, rain dripping from his face.

"We can fix this."

She shook her head slowly.

"No...you don't understand."

Then help me understand.

"Take care of yourself, Bayo."

And just like that...

She walked away.

CHAPTER 16: THE AFTERMATH

Silence returned.

But this time...

It was permanent.

Bayo's room felt smaller than ever.

Not because it changed.

But because something was missing.

He sat on the edge of his bed, staring at nothing.

No music.

No distractions.

Just thoughts.

Moments replayed.

Over and over.

"What could I have done differently?"

"Was it my fault?"

"Did I push too hard?"



CHAPTER 17: LOST

Days blurred into each other.

Work became mechanical.

Sleep became inconsistent.

Life...

Became heavy.

Bayo walked through the city like a shadow.

Present.

But not fully there.

He passed places that held memories.

And each one...

Felt like a reminder.

Of what was. And what no longer existed.

“Maybe this is just how it is,” he muttered one night.

“Maybe this is what the diaspora does to people.”

It builds you.

But it also tests you.

In ways you never expected.



CHAPTER 18: MIDNIGHT THOUGHTS

The road was quiet.

Streetlights stretched endlessly ahead.

Bayo drove without a destination.

Just movement.

Just escape.

His hands rested loosely on the steering wheel.

His mind... somewhere else entirely.

"Why does it hurt this much?" he whispered.

Because it wasn't just about her.

It was about everything she represented.

Connection.

Belonging, in a place that never felt like one.

And losing that...

Felt like losing more than just a person.

It felt like losing a version of himself.

He slowed the car slightly.

Looking ahead. Then exhaled deeply.



CHAPTER 19: STILLNESS

Silence didn't feel the same anymore.

It wasn't heavy.

It wasn't suffocating.

It was... still.

Bayo sat quietly, his hands resting on his knees, his eyes fixed on the patterned floor beneath him.

The mosque was calm.

Not empty — but peaceful in a way the outside world never seemed to be.

Soft light filtered through the windows, settling gently across the room. For the first time in a long while...

He wasn't thinking about her.

He wasn't replaying conversations.

He wasn't asking questions.

He was just... present.

And in that stillness, something shifted.

Not dramatically.

Not all at once.

Because healing doesn't arrive loudly.

It comes quietly... when you finally stop resisting yourself.

Bayo closed his eyes briefly. *"I'll be okay."*

This time...



— CHAPTER 20: HER PEACE —

Across the city, in a different space entirely—
Teju sat alone in a church.

The stained glass reflected soft colors across to the walls,
casting a quiet warmth that felt almost... protective.

Her hands rested gently in her lap.
Her breathing was slow.
Steady.

She hadn't come here for answers.
Not anymore.
She had come for peace.

Because somewhere along the way, she realized
something important:

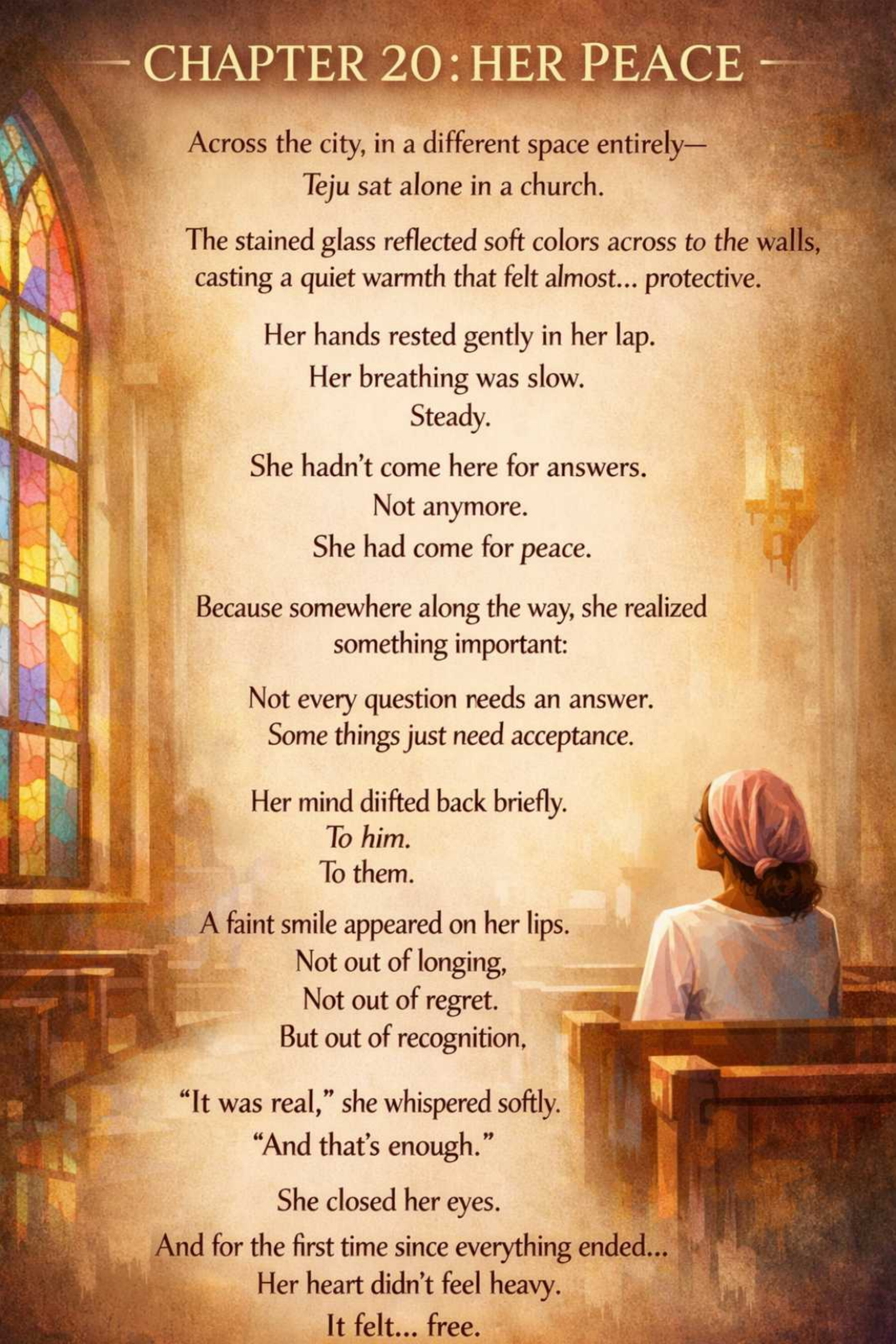
Not every question needs an answer.
Some things just need acceptance.

Her mind drifted back briefly.
To him.
To them.

A faint smile appeared on her lips.
Not out of longing,
Not out of regret.
But out of recognition,

"It was real," she whispered softly.
"And that's enough."

She closed her eyes.
And for the first time since everything ended...
Her heart didn't feel heavy.
It felt... free.



CHAPTER 21: REBUILDING

Growth doesn't always look dramatic.

Sometimes...

It looks like routine.

Bayo woke up earlier now.

Not because he had to.

But because he wanted to.

His room felt different.

Still small.

Still simple.

But no longer empty.

Because he had filled it.

With discipline.

With focus.

With purpose.

Work improved.

His mind became clearer.

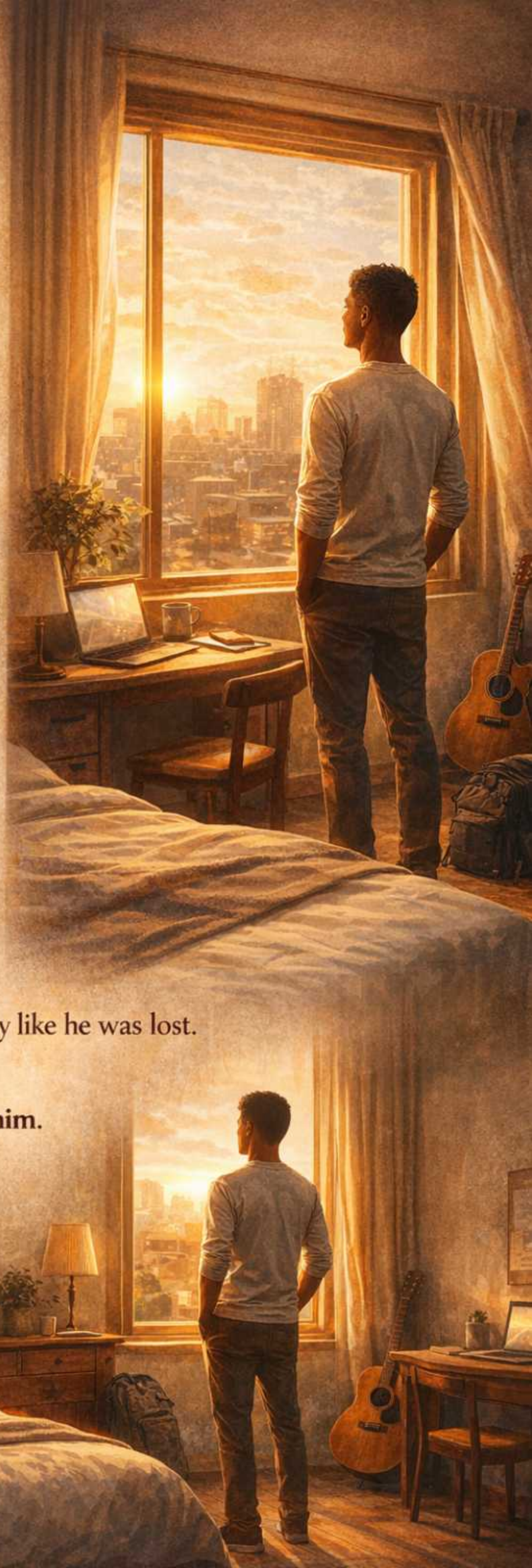
His steps... more intentional.

He no longer walked through the city like he was lost.

He walked like he belonged.

Not because the city had **accepted him**.

**But because he
had accepted himself within it.**



CHAPTER 22: BECOMING

There's a moment in life when you realize—
You're not who you used to be.
And that's not a loss.
It's evolution.

Bayo stood by the same window he used to sit beside.
Looking out at the same street.
But this time...

He wasn't watching people.
He wasn't comparing.
He wasn't wondering.

He was simply observing.

Calm.
Grounded.
Certain.

"I needed that," he said quietly.
Not referring to the pain.
But to everything it forced him to become.

Because sometimes...
What breaks you...
Also builds you.



CHAPTER 23: THE UNEXPECTED

Life doesn't always announce its turning points.

Sometimes...

It just places them in front of you.

Bayo wasn't looking for her.

Not anyone.

That's why it caught him off guard.

She stood there.

Just a few steps away.

Unchanged... yet completely different.

Teju.

Their eyes met.

And for a brief moment—

Everything returned.

Not the pain.

Not the tension.

But the familiarity.

“Hi,” she said softly.

Bayo nodded.

“Hi.”

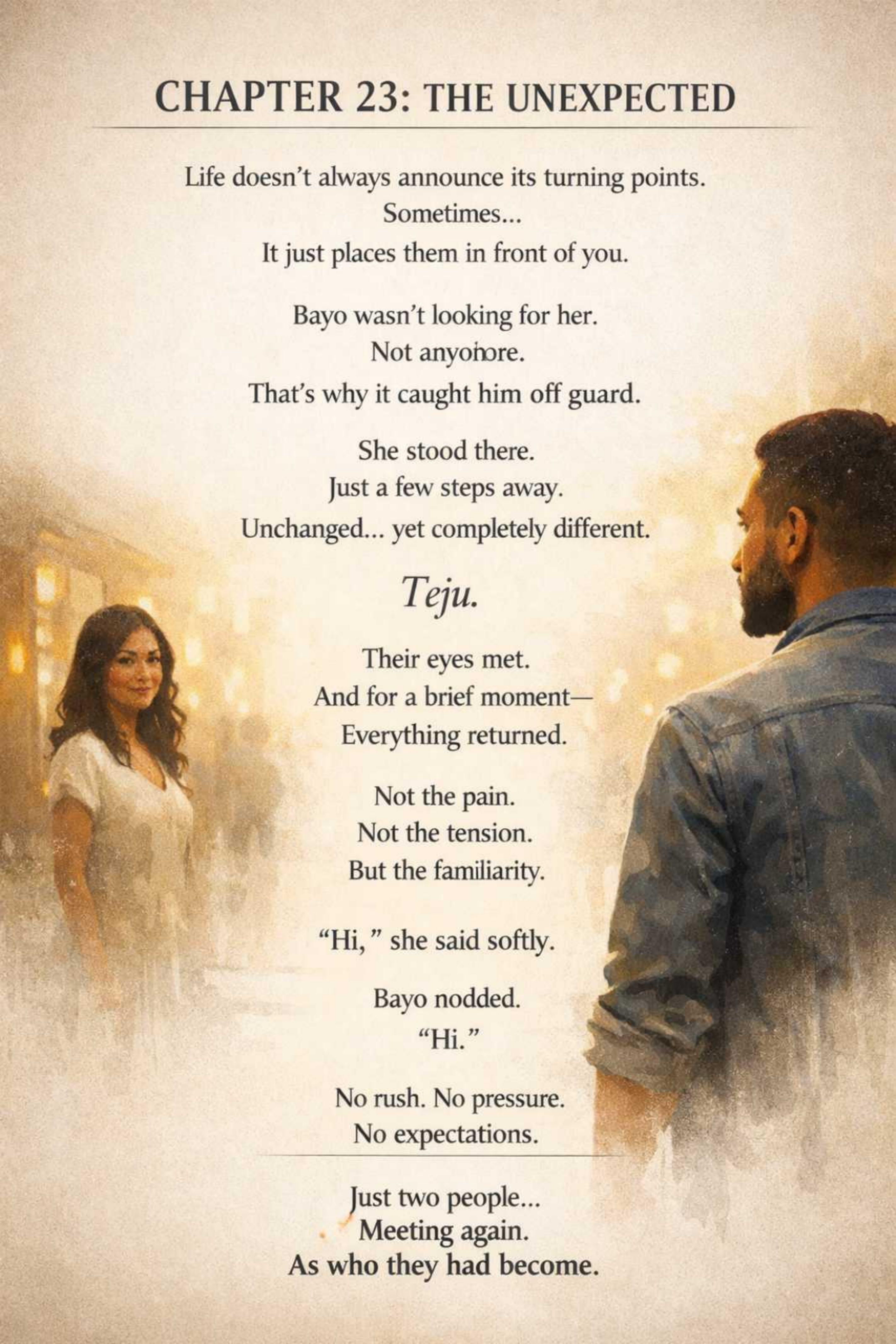
No rush. No pressure.

No expectations.

Just two people...

Meeting again.

As who they had become.



CHAPTER 24: TRUTH WITHOUT DEFENSE

They sat across from each other.
The same kind of setting where everything had once begun.

But this time...
There was no confusion.
No hidden emotions.
No fear.

"I'm sorry," Teju said.
Not dramatically.
Just honestly.

Bayo shook his head slightly.
"You don't need to be."

"I do," she replied.
"For not understanding myself at the time."

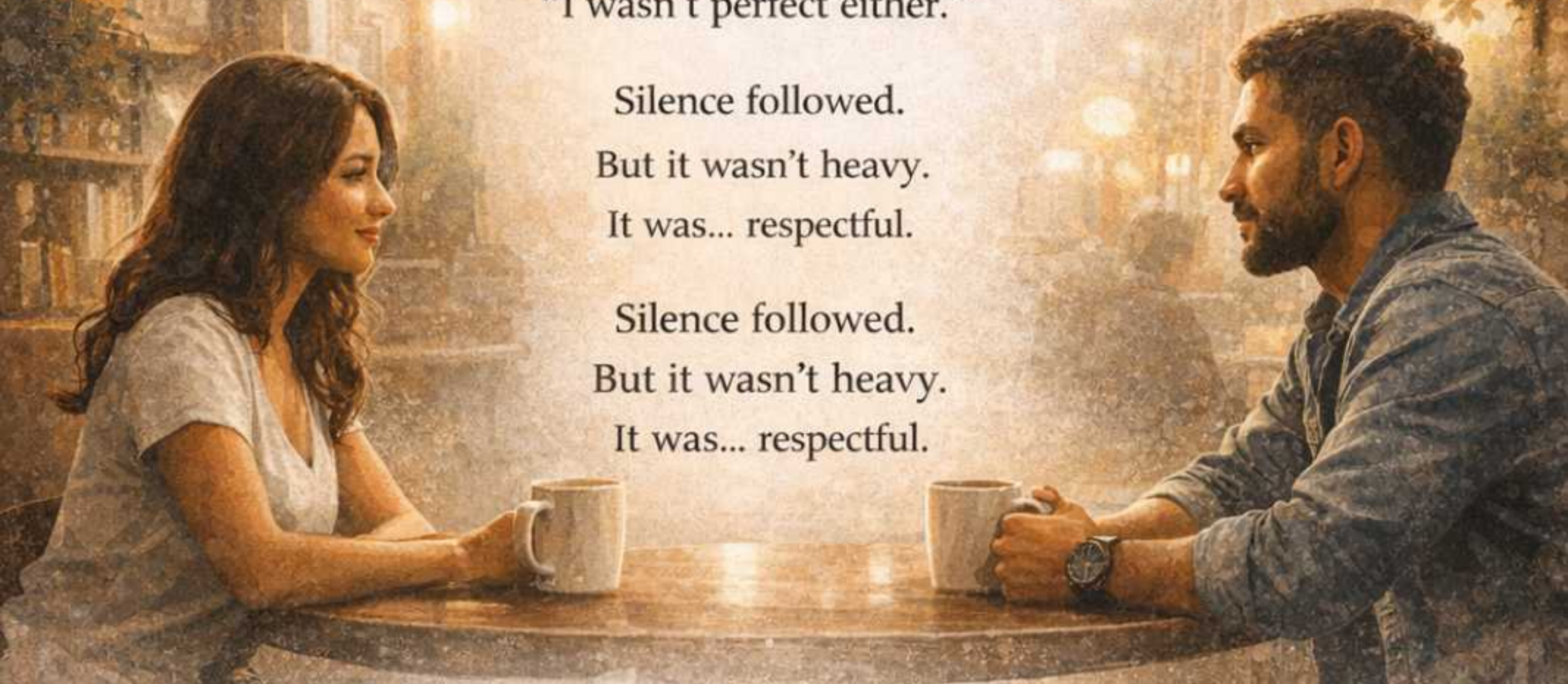
He nodded slowly.
"I wasn't perfect either."

Silence followed.
But it wasn't heavy.
It was... respectful.

Silence followed.
But it wasn't heavy.
It was... respectful.

Silence followed.
But it wasn't heavy.
It was... respectful.

"I think we needed that distance," she said.
Bayo agreed.
"Yeah... we did."



CHAPTER 25:

CHOOSING AGAIN

*Love is different the second time.
It's not driven by excitement,
It's guided by understanding.*

"Where do we go from here?" Teju asked.

*Bayo paused.
Not because he didn't know.
But because this time...
He wanted to choose carefully.*

*"We don't rush," he said.
"We don't force anything."*

She nodded. "And we don't lose ourselves again."

He smiled slightly. "Exactly."

*No grand gestures.
No dramatic promises.*

*Just a decision.
To try again.
But differently.*





*“ Sometimes, leaving home is
not about distance...
but about becoming who you
were meant to be. ”*



THE END



Thank you for reading.



ABOUT THE AUTHOR



Gabriel M. Gishmaf

Gabriel M. Gishmaf is a storyteller passionate about capturing the emotional realities of life in the diaspora.

Through cinematic and deeply human storytelling, his work explores identity, love, growth, and the silent battles faced while building a life far from home.

This book marks the beginning of a powerful storytelling journey.

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Stay connected for upcoming releases
and future seasons of

THE DIASPORA LOVE STORY



About the Author

Gabriel M. Gishmaf is a multi-talented professional with expertise in software engineer, mechanical engineering, digital forensics, and cyber investigation. He is also a published author of *Escape from the Street* and *A Lonely Life Survivor*, capturing stories of resilience and growth.



In a foreign land where survival comes before dreams, Bayo finds himself navigating loneliness, identity, and purpose. Then he meets Teju.

What begins as a simple encounter becomes something deeper—A connection filled with emotion, distance, growth, and **truth**. But

In the diaspora... Love is never simple.



Some connections heal you.
And some... do both.

[https://gishmaf-website-2.
onrender.com](https://gishmaf-website-2.onrender.com)